

Figure 2.22 *Nizamabad, Iran, wall fragment with stucco decoration, Sasanian/early Islamic? From Kröger 1982.*

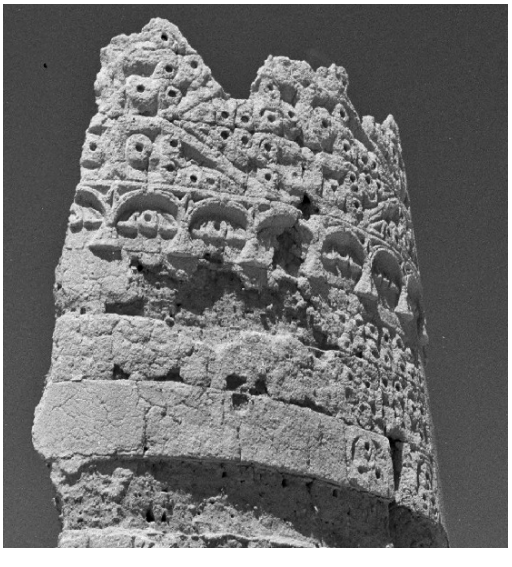


Figure 2.23 *Detail of Figure 2.16: Male Alau, Ghor Province, brick tower, upper decoration. © After Josephine Powell* c. *1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

The proposal of a late seventh–tenth century span for the initial construction of central–southern Ghur's architectural remains – their renovation, repurposing, and reuse possibly continuing well into the twelfth century and beyond – also concords with the region's historical trajectory. Given the significance of Sistan–Khurasan for both Sasanian imperial consolidation, and the later Sasanians' lingering rebellions against the onslaught of Arab-Umayyad ascendancy (see below), the presence of pre-Islamic